

Does character ai use water for their servers/llm?

Posted by u/Hihihihihihih1h1 • 0 points • 5 comments

I know the servers going down thing has already passed but I am wondering this question along with if cai actually uses water like a lot of people say they are for their servers and the ai generating a response (usually lumped in with other confirmed ai's like gemini and chatgpt that does in fact reduce the earth's water by bigger companies like openai and google.) But when searching for this I find zero answers.

I'm kinda skeptical about the claim cai could be using a lot of water for their responses, since in early 2022 before it blew up on tiktok and was still a niche site, it still generated responses like how it does today. If you have resources/articles about cai specifically on this topic it'd be helpful.

Comments

u/iammedotnet • 2 points • 2025-08-19 20:42 UTC

It's mainly about how the servers take the water from the local communities, the water will come back down but not in the same place. Water vapour is also a greenhouse gas so it contributes to global warming.

u/SilverbackRon • 1 points • 2025-05-09 05:26 UTC

They don't use any more water or energy, nor create more environmental issues than anything else you do on the internet. YouTube? TikTok? Google? Tens of thousands of times more energy consumption/cooling required.

Some people like to shitpost fake moral outrage or fearmongering.

u/ra0nZB0iRy • 3 points • 2025-05-09 01:35 UTC

I have a locally hosted LLM and whenever I send any messages to it, my fans start working in overtime so presumably it is using up a lot of energy but, like, whatever. The usage of nonrenewable fuel (gas, for where I live) is more problematic than the usage of water which cycles and at least I live near one of the largest power plants in the world and they get their water from the ocean, not any freshwater source.

So idk.

u/GlitteringTone6425 • 2 points • 2025-05-08 20:39 UTC

uh did you forget about the water cycle? or CONSERVATION OF MASS

all data centers, which the internet relies on, need cooling, not just "ai ones". stop with the moral panic bullshit, if you're worried about water waste, go live in the woods off the grid.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-09-30 17:58 UTC

[removed]

u/Evil_Moose_Mwahaha • 1 points • 2025-08-30 05:53 UTC

what are you talking about? just because waters energy/mass doesnt dissapear from existence doesnt mean we dont lose it. when we say losing water or using water, thats in regards to freshwater resources being depleted. which is caused by using it faster than it can replenish. the water cycle isnt some magical phenomenon that makes sure to sprinkle enough water into every freshwater body to replenish it. lots of it goes into the ground or back into the ocean. and ai models in 2023 used 10x the energy as a normal search. and ai models have gotten even larger since then.

u/soxisindebiltown • 2 points • 2025-08-28 07:38 UTC

Honestly thank you I've been so worried about using ai as a way to cope with how extremely lonely things are for me. I'd love to use fanfic but they're never inclusive enough queer wise and every time I write anymore I feel like I sound like an idiot and get discouraged. Thank you.

u/fseed • 4 points • 2025-05-08 20:24 UTC

Unless we start ejecting water out into space, there is no reduction of water on the Earth happening at all. When data centers use water for cooling, it typically evaporates, enters the atmosphere, and eventually returns as precipitation. So while local freshwater resources might be strained (especially if a facility draws heavily from a dry region), it's not like the planet is being "de-watered."

To my knowledge, c.ai is likely leasing inference/GPU power from a company like DeepInfra or similar. Those providers tend to publish environmental impact reports if you're curious.

TikTok is a dumpster fire for credible info.

u/Evil_Moose_Mwahaha • 0 points • 2025-08-30 05:51 UTC

nobody is making the argument that water molecules are being atomically split apart. servers do you specifically freshwater. a valuable resource we seem to forget the fragility of.

u/Hihihihihihih1h1 • 1 points • 2025-09-02 14:18 UTC

Not true, after knowing more about this topic, a lot of the data centers actually reuse water that they already had and recycled waste water, not draining anymore freshwater than using a microwave or watching netflix.

u/Evil_Moose_Mwahaha • 1 points • 2025-09-18 04:42 UTC

first of all, none of that information contradicts what i said. I said the argument is that it uses fresh water taken out of the ecosystem and that the water isnt atomically split apart, so its still around. none of what you go on to say opposes this, it just says that said freshwater extracted isnt enough to mean anything.

And to that, I'd say if that were true we wouldnt see accounts of how the

intense energy and water demand of ai is affecting communities in ways that arent matched by....microwave manufacturing(?) or netflix servers.

u/Hihihihihihihih1h1 • 2 points • 2025-05-09 00:42 UTC

Thanks for a more constructive comment, a lot of people hammer the same rhetoric so it's hard to tell what really is the 'issue'.